3. Lapoliths

When the magma moves upwards, a saucer shape, concave shaped body called Lapolith is formed.

4. Sill

Sill is a solidified sheet-like horizontal lava layer inside the earth. The near horizontal bodies of the intrusive igneous rocks are called sill or sheet, depending on the thickness of the material. The thinner ones are called sheets while the thick horizontal deposits are called sills.

5. Dyke

When the magma makes its way through cracks and the fissures developed in the land, it solidifies almost perpendicular to the ground. It gets cooled in the same position to develop a wall-like structure. Such structures are called dikes.

These are the most commonly found intrusive forms in the western Maharashtra area. These are considered the feeders for the eruptions that led to the development of the Deccan traps.

II. Sedimentary Rocks

Sedimentary rocks are also called as detrital rocks. They are formed as a result of denudation. These deposits through compaction turn into sedimentary rocks. They occupy only 5 percent of the earth. They are layered or stratified of varying thickness. Example: sandstone, shale etc. Ice deposited sedimentary rocks is called Till. Wind-deposited sediments are called Loess.

Depending upon the mode of formation, sedimentary rocks are classified into

1. Mechanically formed sedimentary rocks: sandstone, conglomerate, limestone, shale, loess, etc.
2. Organically formed sedimentary rocks: geyserites, chalk, limestone, coal etc.
3. Chemically formed: halite, potash, etc.

III. Metamorphic Rocks

The word metamorphic means 'change of form'. The metamorphic rocks form under the action of pressure, volume and temperature (PVT) change.

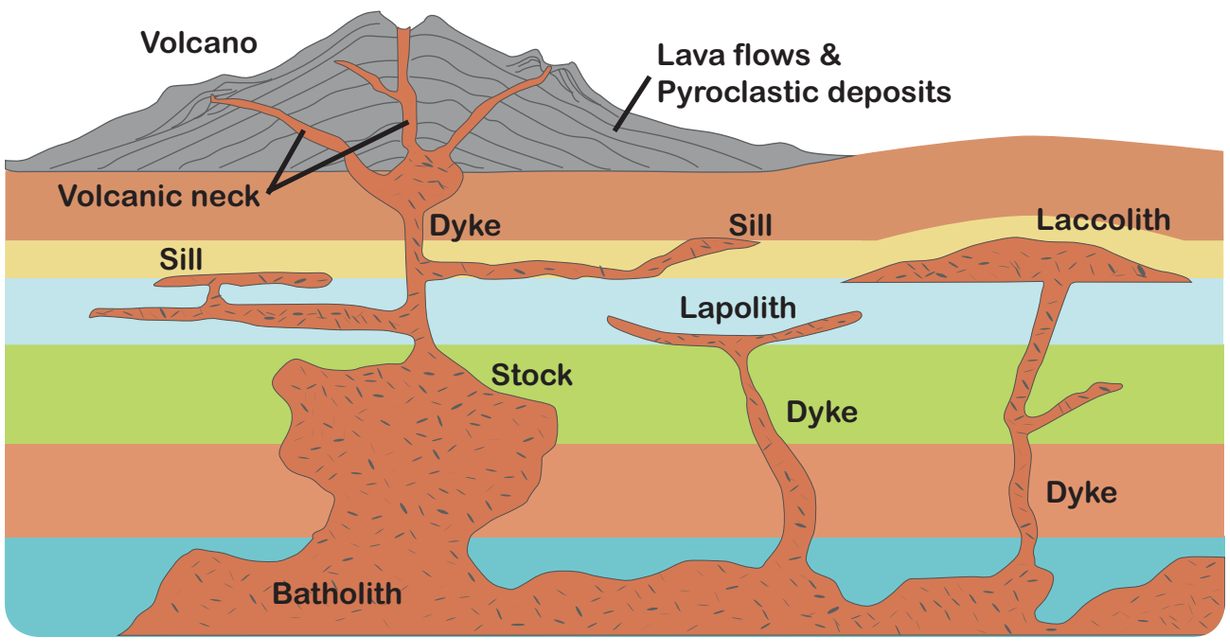


Figure 3.26 Intrusive Volcanic structure

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